

WORKERSARENA · BEIRUT · LEBANON

Business Model, Usage Guide & Worker Revenue Stream

The complete plain-text reference: how the marketplace makes money, how each participant uses it step by step, how a worker earns and is paid, and where the model should be improved next.

DOCUMENT

Plain-text business reference (PDF)

VERSION

1.0 — 23 September 2026

TENANT

Lebanon (Beirut) · USD · AR/EN bilingual

LIVE RAILS

OMT & Whish Money (manual, admin-confirmed)

PRODUCTION

<https://workers-arena.vercel.app>

Contents

- Section 1 — The Existing Business Model.** What the platform is, the participants, all revenue streams with their exact prices, the payment rails, and the collection rule that makes the take rate real money.
- Section 2 — Step-by-Step: How to Use It.** Four complete journeys — worker, customer, company/advertiser, and administrator — from first click to money settled, including every OMT/Whish confirmation loop.
- Section 3 — The Worker Revenue Stream.** How a worker earns, two fully-worked numeric examples, the monthly economics per plan tier, the money waterfall, the payout lifecycle, and the dashboards that measure it.
- Section 4 — Recommendations for Areas of Improvement.** Prioritised recommendations across monetisation, trust & quality, operations & data, growth, and risk — each with why it matters, effort, and expected impact.

HOW THIS DOCUMENT WAS PRODUCED

Generated 23 September 2026 from the repository's living documentation and code: docs/BUSINESS-MODEL.md, docs/BUSINESS-MODEL-SUMMARY.md, docs/REVENUE-STREAMS.md, docs/PAYMENTS.md, docs/booking-settlement.md, docs/booking-take-rate.md, docs/payouts.md, docs/ADVERTISING-SYSTEM.md. All prices, rates and formulas below are the defaults as implemented; every one of them is admin-editable at runtime, so the live site may differ after a configuration change. Figures marked *illustrative* are modelled projections, not measurements.

Section 1 — The Existing Business Model

1.1 What the platform is

WorkersArena is a **two-sided local-services marketplace** for home and commercial work — plumbers, electricians, cleaners, AC technicians, carpenters, painters and more. It has a third, business-facing side: **companies** that buy advertising. The product is bilingual (Arabic RTL / English LTR), prices everything in **US dollars**, and currently serves **Beirut, Lebanon** as its city. Profiles, quotes, bookings, reviews, lead offers and invoices all exist in both languages.

The commercial thesis is deliberately layered: **workers pay to be seen** (subscription), **workers pay to compete** (credits → leads), **the platform takes a cut of work won** (take rate, refunded partly by lead rebates), **trust is sold** (verification, featured slots, emergency markers), and **companies pay to reach the audience** (advertising). Customers — the demand side — are intentionally **free**, because charging bookers early would throttle the network effect that makes every other stream worth anything.

The four participants

Participant	What they do	What they pay
Worker (supply)	Builds a profile with prices, certificates, hours and availability; buys leads; sends quotes; takes bookings; gets paid through the platform's ledger.	Subscription (\$7.50–\$299/mo depending on plan × trade multiplier), lead credits (\$1 each), paid verification (\$9/\$19), featured (\$49/category/mo), emergency marker (\$9/mo), plus the take rate on completed jobs.
Customer (demand)	Searches, browses, favourites, reviews, requests jobs, pays deposit and balance.	Nothing to the platform — the job price is paid to the worker; the platform's fee comes out of the worker's side.
Company (B2B)	Runs advertising campaigns across 8 ad formats with city/category targeting and ROI analytics.	Campaign budgets — priced at ~\$10 CPM / \$1 CPC in the current model.
Admin (platform)	Confirms manual payments, approves payouts, edits every price and rule, reviews lead refunds, sends WhatsApp outreach, reconciles money.	Collects every stream listed below.

1.2 The revenue architecture — every stream at a glance

All monetisable surfaces as implemented. "Status" distinguishes what collects money today from what is built but waiting on a gateway.

#	Revenue stream	Status	Pricing as configured
1	Worker subscriptions	LIVE	\$15 / \$39 / \$99 / \$199 per month × trade multiplier (0.5×–1.5×); annual = 9 months for 12
2	Platform fee (take rate)	LIVE	4%–12% of job quote, min \$5, max \$300 per job
3	Lead marketplace	LIVE	5 / 9 / 20 / 35 credits per grade (Bronze→Emergency), smart-pricing 0.7×–2.0×

#	Revenue stream	Status	Pricing as configured
4	Credit purchases	LIVE	\$10 / \$25 / \$50 / \$100 packages, bonus credits up to +30
5	Lead rebates	LIVE	Lead cost credited back against the platform fee on conversion (loyalty loop)
6	Paid verification	LIVE	\$9 Basic (ID) / \$19 Professional (licence + background), 12-month validity
7	Featured slot	LIVE	\$49 per category per month, homepage placement
8	Emergency marker	LIVE	\$9 per month, 24/7 urgent-job badge + emergency lead offers
9	Referral program	LIVE	25 credits to referrer, 10 to invitee, cap 10/month, qualifies on first booking
10	Company advertising	BUILT · manual rails	~\$10 CPM + \$1 CPC, 8 ad types, 6 placements, activation gated on payment
11	Smart pricing	LIVE	Lead-price multiplier 0.7x–2.0x (rush, weekend, season, holidays, supply/demand, emergency)
12	Promotions engine	LIVE	Campaign-driven credit bonuses, admin-created
13	Recurring jobs	LIVE	Cron materialises recurring occurrences → repeat GMV and repeat fees
14	Retention / analytics surfaces	BUILT	ROI dashboard, earnings statement, lead-quality analytics, retention export — measurement, not billing

1.3 Stream detail

A. Worker subscriptions — the recurring base

Plan	Monthly	Annual (9 mo)	Leads/mo	What it unlocks
Starter	\$15	\$135	3	Profile + search listing (the paywall starts here)
Growth	\$39	\$351	10	+ featured placement eligibility, verification, more leads
Pro	\$99	\$891	25	+ priority matching, analytics, emergency marker
Business	\$199	\$1,791	Unlimited	+ reduced 4% take rate, team management

Annual billing = pay 9 months, get 12 (25% off). New plans/prices are edited at /admin/revenue-settings, never hard-coded.

- **Category-adjusted pricing.** Trades are classified by average job value: *low-value* (cleaning, gardening, pest control) $\times 0.5 \rightarrow$ Starter \$7.50; *mid-value* (plumbing, electrical, carpentry) $\times 1.0 \rightarrow$ \$15; *high-value* (HVAC, satellite, mechanic) $\times 1.5 \rightarrow$ \$22.50. The same price $\times$ multiplier is used on the instructions page, the invoice and the subscription record.
- **Trial policy.** Starter/Growth get 30 days free, Pro 14 days, Business is assisted by default. Eligibility is checked server-side, once per worker; a lapsed trial never reopens.
- **The paywall (visibility gating).** An expired subscription removes the worker from public search. Search visibility is workers' #1 KPI, so expiry doubles as the highest-converting upsell trigger, reinforced by 7/3/1-day renewal reminders (cron + dashboard banner) and an "expiring" status.

- **Invoicing.** Every confirmed renewal mints an INV-* invoice with the exact charged amount.

B. Platform fee (take rate) — the headline lever

Plan tier	Rate	Floor	Cap	Formula
Free	12%	\$5	\$300	$\text{fee} = \text{clamp}(\text{round}(\text{quote} \times \text{bps} / 10000), 500, 30000)$ rounded half-up to the minor unit, then clamped
Starter	9%	\$5	\$300	
Growth	7%	\$5	\$300	
Pro	5%	\$5	\$300	
Business	4% reduced	\$5	\$300	

- **Stamped once, never recomputed.** The fee is written at *accept-with-quote* as an immutable PlatformFeeSnapshot (amount + rate-in-bps audit trail). Later rate changes cannot rewrite history.
- **Shown on both sides.** The worker's respond dialog previews "*Quote / Platform fee / You receive*" live as they type; the customer's booking row shows "*\$80 · Includes platform fee \$5.60 · Worker receives \$74.40*" — transparency is a trust feature, and both surfaces call the same pure calculator.
- **Overrides.** Admins can set per-category and per-promotion rules, and can mark a rule explicitly exempt — only an explicit exempt rule renders "waived"; Business/Enterprise are merely *reduced-rate* by default.

C. Lead marketplace — selling qualified demand

Grade	Price	What the customer supplied
Bronze	5 credits (\$5)	Basic request info, no email
Silver	9 credits (\$9)	Email + category + location
Gold	20 credits (\$20)	Full profile + photos + signed in
Emergency	35 credits (\$35)	24/7 urgent request

- **Matching engine.** Weighted score decides who even sees the offer: trade 30%, area 12%, rating 12%, response rate 10%, city 8%, availability 8%, reviews 6%, plan tier 6%, emergency fit 5%, verified 3% (= 100).
- **Ownership.** Exclusive by default — buying revokes rivals' offers — capped at maxWorkersPerLead (default 3 shown) with a time-based expiry window (default 2 hours).
- **Contact reveal ladder.** hidden → masked → revealed, by purchase status and plan tier; after a booking, the customer's consent reveals it. A free-plan buyer keeps a masked contact after purchase — a deliberate plan-tier lever.
- **Quality feedback loop.** Workers rate a purchased lead 1–5 stars; the rating drives per-grade price multipliers (0.8× discount ... 1.2× surcharge) and nudges matching weights, with an admin lead-quality analytics dashboard.

D. Platform credits — the pre-paid unit of demand

Package	Credits	Price	Bonus	Total
Starter	10	\$10	0	10
Popular	25	\$25	+5	30
Professional	50	\$50	+15	65
Enterprise	100	\$100	+30	130

1 credit = \$1 by convention. Bonus credits are promotional and itemised separately. Balance is *derived* from an append-only WorkerCreditEntry ledger — never stored — so every grant, spend and refund adjustment is auditable.

Workers may request **one refund per purchased lead** (invalid contact, duplicate, wrong category/area, customer never requested the service, unreachable customer). Admins review evidence and approve full or partial credit returns; approvals append an adjustment row — the original spend row is never edited or deleted, and duplicates are rejected.

E. Lead rebate — buying leads lowers the take rate you pay

THE LOYALTY LOOP

When a bought lead converts to a completed job, the lead's cost is credited back against the platform fee:
 $\text{rebate} = \min(\text{fee} \times \text{pctBps}/10000, \text{lead cost}, \text{ceiling})$ — default 100% of the fee share, no ceiling. The stamped fee is never rewritten; the rebate is recorded in an append-only LeadRebate row.

Worked example (default rules)

Quote	= \$300.00	Growth worker → 7% take rate
Platform fee (stamped)	= \$21.00	7% × 300, inside the \$5–\$300 band
Gold lead the worker BOUGHT	= \$20.00	(20 credits spent earlier)
Rebate	= \$20.00	$\min(21 \times 100\%, 20, \infty)$
Platform keeps	= \$1.00	effective take rate on this job ≈ 0.33%
Worker nets	= \$299.00	(\$300 – \$21 fee + \$20 rebate)

The rebate is the mechanism that answers the classic worker objection — "I paid for a lead *and* you take a cut". Both costs are real, but only one is returned when the lead actually wins work.

F. Paid trust: verification, featured, emergency

Product	Price	Delivered
Verification — Basic	\$9	ID check, badge in search, 12-month validity
Verification — Professional	\$19	Licence + background check, badge, 12-month validity
Featured slot	\$49 / category / mo	Homepage featured-worker section placement
Emergency marker	\$9 / mo	"Available 24/7" badge + eligibility for emergency lead offers

Each is purchased through the same OMT/Whish rail and flipped on by the admin's confirmation — the worker's upgrade dialog offers all three inline.

G. Referral program — supply growth as a credit cost

- Referrer **+25 credits** per successful referral · Invitee **+10 credits** on signup.
- Qualifying action: the invitee must **complete their first booking** (credits are not paid for a bare signup).
- Cap: **10 referrals per worker per month**, lifetime unlimited. Configurable via `FeeRuleSet.referral`.

H. Company advertising — the dormant B2B engine

- **8 ad types:** banner, slider, featured card, sponsored search, sponsored category, popup, native, video.
- **6 placements:** search results top, category page, worker-profile sidebar, sticky mobile banner (24h-dismissible), weekly email digest (with tracking pixel), retargeting overlay (fires after 2+ views or a <30s bounce).
- **Pricing model as built:** impressions burn \$0.01 and clicks burn \$1 — i.e. roughly **\$10 CPM + \$1 CPC**. Targeting by city and category; rotation; impression/click/CTR/CPC/ROAS analytics.
- **Activation gate:** campaign creation mints a PENDING invoice + payment, the company pays, and only the admin/webhook confirmation flips it to ACTIVE. `getActiveAdsFor` matches ACTIVE only — an unpaid campaign never serves an impression.
- **Status flow:** PENDING (unpaid) → ACTIVE (live) ⇌ PAUSED → ENDED; refunds end the campaign and void the invoice as a credit note.

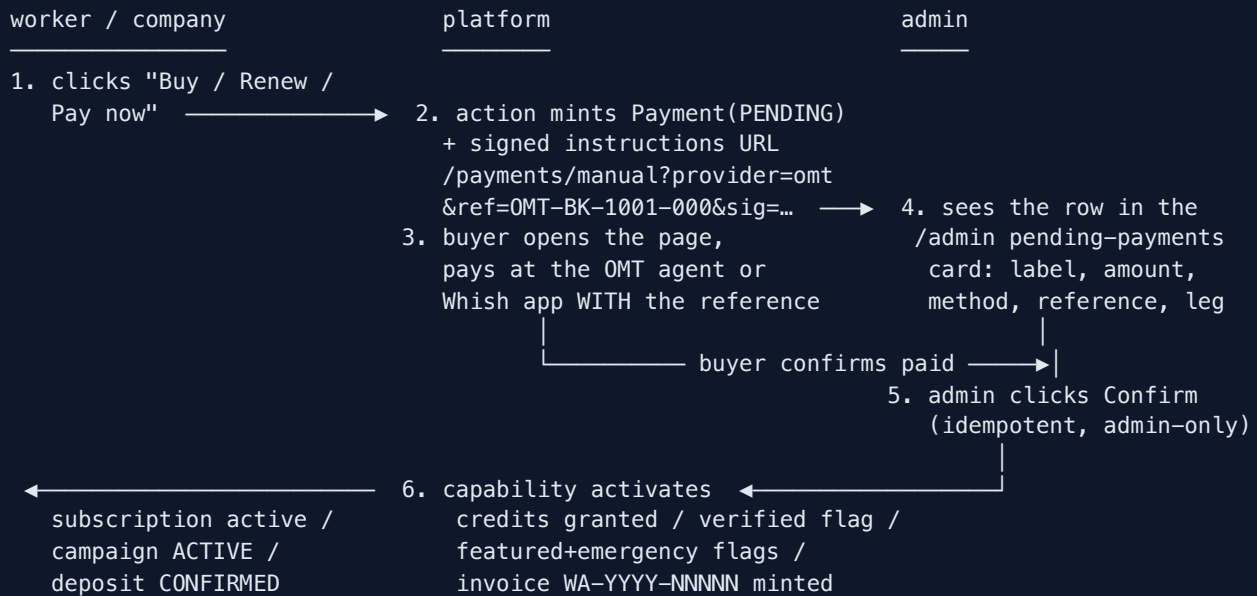
I. Smart pricing — what a lead is worth changes by the hour

Factor	Multiplier
Rush hour (6–9 AM, 5–8 PM)	+15%
Weekend (Sat–Sun)	+10–20%
Seasonal — AC in summer / plumbing in winter	+25% / +15%
Holidays (Ramadan, Eid, Christmas)	+30–35%
Supply/demand imbalance	0.7×–2.0×
Emergency dispatch premium (bounded)	≤1.5×
Lead-quality rating (worker feedback)	0.8×–1.2×
Everything is clamped to [0.7, 2.0]. The final multiplier + human-readable reason are persisted on the offer at creation, so a worker or admin can audit exactly why a price was what it was — and existing offers are never repriced.	

1.4 How money is actually collected: the OMT / Whish manual rail

Payment automation (Stripe and MENA gateways) is **intentionally deferred**. Everything that costs money runs on Lebanon's two cash networks with no gateway keys and no webhook — the platform mints a **signed instructions page**, the buyer pays offline with a reference, and an admin confirms receipt. It is the manual twin of a provider webhook, and it currently carries all eight flows: subscription renewals, credit purchases, verification, featured, emergency, advertising campaigns, booking deposits and booking balances.

THE MANUAL PAYMENT LOOP (identical for every purchase type)



- **Tamper-proof without a webhook:** each provider signs with its own salt and reference prefix (OMT- / WHISH-); the instructions page verifies the signature through the same contract the webhook route uses.
- **Idempotent per method:** re-clicking the same method returns the already-minted URL; switching method re-mints, so a stale Stripe pre-mint can never leak a simulate URL to a Whish click.
- **Refunds follow the payer:** a cancel resolves the provider that took the money — an OMT-paid deposit refunds via the OMT provider, not a default.
- **Reconciliation:** every row lands in the admin ledger and exports as CSV (status, reference, timestamps, invoice, leg). A cron cancels unpaid subscription renewals older than 7 days and records the lifecycle event; workers can cancel their own pending renewal immediately.
- **Keyless mode:** with no Stripe keys, dev/tests use a simulated provider that completes instantly; in production the registry *refuses* simulation, so the card path stays closed until real keys exist.

1.5 The rule that makes the take rate real money

COLLECTION INVARIANT

The ledger never credits more than the platform has collected, and the fee is only ever taken out of money actually received. One pure function — `settlementFor(facts)` — is the single decision point, called by both database adapters, the customer's pay card, the worker's banner, the payout guard and the admin reconciliation. No surface reads raw payment rows to decide whether a worker can be paid.

A booking's value arrives on **two legs**: the *deposit* before the work (`Booking.paymentId`) and the *settlement* — the outstanding balance after it (`Booking.settlementPaymentId`). The admin's queue tags each row with a leg (`deposit | settlement`) so an operator can never confirm the wrong amount for the right booking.

Where a job's money can stand, and what the worker's ledger receives.

State	Meaning	Credited to worker
funded	Collected $\geq$ quote (deposit covered the job)	collected - fee — the classic path

State	Meaning	Credited to worker
part-funded	Deposit landed, balance didn't	Collected part now; the rest as an ADJUSTMENT when the balance is confirmed
awaiting-customer	Nothing collected, nothing requested yet	Nothing
awaiting-confirmation	A manual OMT/Whish reference is issued but unpaid	Nothing — a reference is a promise, not money
outside-platform	The parties settled in cash on the doorstep	Nothing — the fee becomes a claim recoverable tranche-by-tranche from the worker's credit balance
overpaid	Collected > quote (double-paid deposit)	collected – fee, excess flagged for refund
no-quote	Quote-less accept	Nothing (there is no job value)

Why this matters commercially: before this rule existed, a quote-only job credited a payout the platform never collected, and an approved payout paid the worker *out of platform funds*. Every other revenue lever — leads, credits, subscriptions, ads — sits on top of this one, so collection integrity is the foundation of the whole model.

1.6 The money map

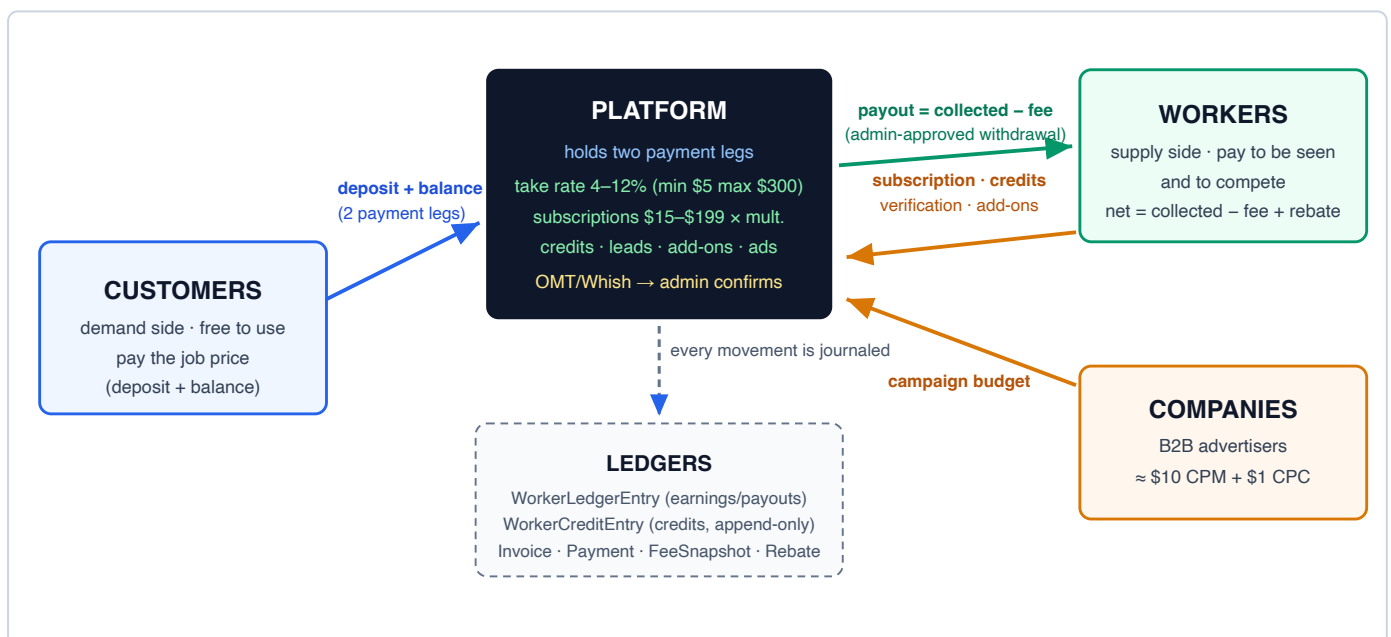


Figure 1 — The money map. Customers fund the platform; workers both fund it and are funded by it; companies fund it for reach; nothing moves without a ledger row.

UNIT ECONOMICS (ILLUSTRATIVE — MODELLED, NOT MEASURED)

Per paying worker per month: subscription \$15–\$199 (mix ≈ \$40–60) + take rate + credit top-ups. The projection in the source docs is \$3.8K month-1 → \$15.5K month-3 → \$46K month-6 → \$127K month-12 total platform revenue at 50 → 1,000 workers. Advertising contributes \$0 today because campaigns still run on manual rails.

Section 2 — Step-by-Step: How to Use It

Four journeys, each written as the literal click-path a person follows, with what the system does at every step. Every payment step is the same OMT/Whish loop shown in §1.4 — the reference changes, the mechanism never does.

2.1 Journey A — the worker, from signup to payout

- 1 **Register and pick a language.** The worker signs up (AR/EN) and lands on the dashboard. A **free trial is applied automatically** server-side: 30 days on Starter/Growth, 14 on Pro, Business assisted. Eligibility is once per worker.
- 2 **Build the profile.** Category, city, area, prices, working hours, certificates, portfolio photos (before/after), languages. Profile quality directly feeds the matching engine (trade 30% + area 12% + city 8%).
- 3 **Choose a plan before the trial ends.** The public pricing page shows category-adjusted prices — a cleaner sees \$7.50 Starter, an HVAC technician \$22.50. The renew dialog quotes monthly vs annual (9-for-12) and labels the change as upgrade / downgrade / unchanged with the price difference previewed.
- 4 **Pay the subscription (OMT/Whish).** Select method → signed / payments/manual page opens with the reference → pay at the OMT agent or in the Whish app → the admin's pending-payments card confirms → subscription activates, invoice mints, visibility is (re)granted. *Until this confirms, an expired plan means the worker is absent from public search.*
- 5 **(Optional) Buy trust products.** The dashboard upgrade dialog sells verification (\$9/\$19), the featured slot (\$49/category/mo) and the emergency marker (\$9/mo) inline, each on the same rail; confirmation flips verified / featured / emergency.
- 6 **Buy credits.** Lead Credits card → "Buy More" → package (\$10/\$25/\$50/\$100 with bonuses) → OMT/Whish → confirmation grants the credits to the append-only ledger. Balance is always derived from entries.
- 7 **Watch the lead board.** Qualified customer requests arrive as graded offers (Bronze 5 → Emergency 35 credits), matched by weighted score, exclusive, expiring on a timer, priced by smart pricing with the reason shown.
- 8 **Unlock a lead.** "Unlock for N credits" debits the ledger idempotently per offer and reveals contact details per the plan-tier policy. Rate the lead 1–5 afterwards — that rating moves future per-grade prices (0.8x–1.2x) and matching weights. A bad lead can be refunded once via the admin review queue.
- 9 **Receive booking requests and respond with a quote.** The respond dialog previews "Quote \$80 · Platform fee \$5.60 · You receive \$74.40" live — the same pure function that stamps the immutable fee snapshot on accept.

- 10 **Set the deposit.** Accept with an optional deposit → the booking goes **PENDING_PAYMENT** → the customer gets a checkout (OMT/Whish instructions) → admin confirms → **CONFIRMED**. The fee was already stamped; times can move later, money cannot.
- 11 **Do the work, complete the job.** On completion the settlement engine reads both legs: if the platform collected $\geq$ quote the ledger is credited collected – fee as an **EARNING** (one per booking, idempotent). If only the deposit landed, the worker sees "waiting for the customer — \$X outstanding".
- 12 **Balance and rebate.** The customer's pay card releases the outstanding balance on the same rails; when it confirms, the difference posts as an **ADJUSTMENT**. If the lead was bought, the rebate posts against the fee — the platform keeps fee – rebate.
- 13 **Read the statements.** The **ROI dashboard** shows leads bought, quotes sent, jobs won, GMV, platform fees, subscription cost, total marketplace spend and the resulting multiple for the month. The **earnings statement** shows completed jobs, GMV, fees, rebates and net earnings per job.
- 14 **Withdraw.** Payouts card → available vs pending balance → request an amount (capped at available – pending; the request reserves the amount) → admin approves or rejects → balance debits only on approval. The worker is notified either way.
- 15 **Refer and repeat.** Share the unique referral code: +25 credits when the invitee completes their first booking, +10 for them at signup, 10 per month. Renewal reminders (7/3/1 day) and the expiring banner keep the subscription alive.

2.2 Journey B — the customer

- 1 **Search or browse.** Category/city/keyword search (Arabic input works — the index handles it), worker profiles with rating, reviews, response rate, availability and verification badges. Featured workers sit on the homepage.
- 2 **Pick a slot and request.** Open the worker's live availability and request a booking — or arrive through a shared ?book=...&slot=... entry link from a WhatsApp thread, which opens the dialog pre-filled (each unusable part is dropped with a reason, never a hard failure).
- 3 **Receive the quote.** The worker responds with a quote and optional deposit. The row is transparent: "\$80 · Includes platform fee \$5.60 · Worker receives \$74.40".
- 4 **Pay the deposit.** Choose OMT or Whish → instructions page with reference → pay offline → admin confirms → booking flips **CONFIRMED** and a WA-YYYY-NNNNN invoice is minted for signed-in customers.
- 5 **Job runs.** Either party can reschedule. Cancellations follow the 24h policy window: customer/system cancels always refund; a worker cancelling inside 24h of start keeps the deposit.

- 6 **Pay the balance after completion.** If the deposit didn't cover the quote, a pay card names the exact outstanding amount on the same rails — paying it is what releases the worker's payout, and the UI says so.
- 7 **Review.** At completion the platform asks for a review (ask now, remind once after 3 days, silent after 30 or once a review exists). Only customers with a completed booking can review — `verifiedPurchase` is computed from the reviewer's own bookings.
- 8 **Follow-up.** Favourites, weekly digest email with sponsored section, and a request path for customers without a worker match — which is what becomes a graded lead on the marketplace.

2.3 Journey C — the company / advertiser

- 1 **Open the company dashboard** and start a campaign builder: bilingual name, one of 8 ad types, placement, budget, date range, and city/category targeting.
- 2 **Pay to activate.** Creation mints a PENDING invoice and payment. "Pay now" issues the OMT/Whish instructions; the campaign stays **PENDING and serves nothing** until the admin confirms — then it flips ACTIVE and the invoice is paid.
- 3 **Ads serve by placement:** sponsored search top, category banner, profile sidebar, sticky mobile banner, weekly digest (pixel-measured), retargeting overlay. Clicks route through `/api/ads/:id/click`.
- 4 **Spend accrues at ~\$0.01/impression and \$1/click against the budget until it is exhausted or the end date passes → ENDED.**

Measure ROI in the analytics view: impressions, clicks, CTR, CPC, CPM, ROAS, placement breakdown, daily performance, budget utilisation, export.

Refund path: admin refund → campaign ENDED, payment REFUNDED, invoice VOID (credit note), company notified with the reason.

2.4 Journey D — the administrator

- 1 **Confirm payments.** The *pending-payments* card lists every OMT/Whish row with ID, scope, bilingual label, amount, method, reference, created time, status and — for bookings — the leg (deposit/settlement). Verify the buyer's reference, click Confirm (idempotent; non-admins get unauthorized), capability activates.
- 2 **Run pricing from revenue settings.** `/admin/revenue-settings` edits plan prices, lead quotas, category multipliers, credit packages, grade prices, matching weights, contact-reveal policy, rebate rules (on/off, share, ceiling), fee ladder and promotions — each publish creates an audit version. Nothing above is hard-coded.

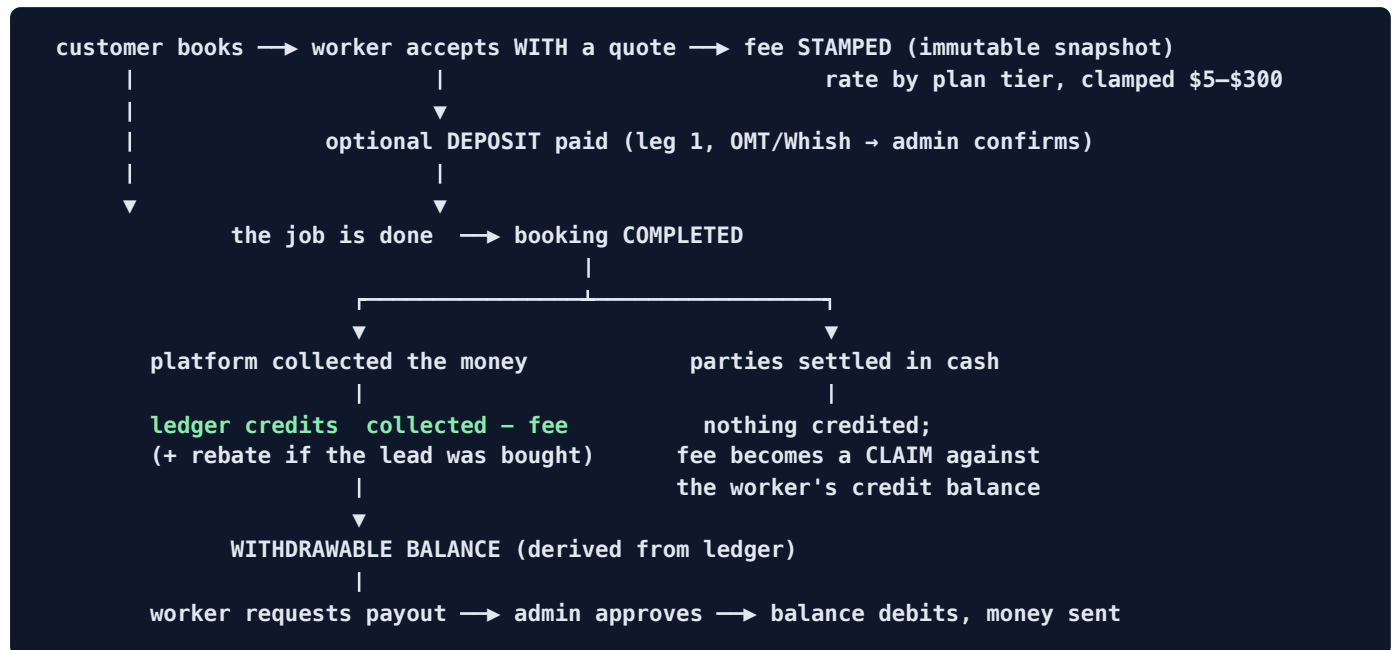
- 3 **Operate the lead market.** The lead-market panel shows offers, credits, rebates, ratings, the smart-price/surge suggestion (one click prefills the emergency base-price adjustment when the 30-day surge verdict says healthy or overpriced), and per-grade WhatsApp templates an admin sends manually to matched workers via a pre-filled wa.me link.
- 4 **Review lead refunds.** One request per lead, evidence reviewed, approve full/partial credit return with a note — appended to the ledger, never rewriting the spend.
- 5 **Approve payouts.** The *pending-payouts* card: worker, amount, time → Approve (PROCESSED, debits balance) or Reject (nothing moves). The decision is a compare-and-swap, so two admins cannot both decide.
- 6 **Reconcile.** The settlement reconciliation card shows fee *stamped* vs fee *collected*, customers being awaited, unbacked credit (must read \$0.00), credit blocked on collection, and outside-platform claims — worst-first. Export the OMT/Whish ledger as CSV for accounting.
- 7 **Watch retention.** The retention panel and `/api/admin/retention` derive trial-to-paid conversion, churn, upgrades/downgrades, average lifetime, renewal revenue/LTV and WhatsApp outreach counts from the append-only SubscriptionEvent ledger — plus at-risk workers ordered by soonest expiry for individual WhatsApp outreach.
- 8 **Watch quality and surge.** Lead-quality analytics (weekly rating trends, per-grade stats, conversion, price-multiplier impact) and the 30-day emergency surge report with a deterministic verdict and CSV decision record; the summary also rides the weekly admin WhatsApp digest.

THE ONE LOOP TO REMEMBER

Every purchase in all four journeys is: buyer action → PENDING payment + signed reference → offline payment → admin confirmation → capability activates → invoice + ledger row. Automation replaces only the last two steps — that is precisely what connecting Stripe (deferred, see §4) would do.

Section 3 — The Worker Revenue Stream

3.1 How a worker earns



Net earnings = GMV – platform fee + lead rebates. Marketplace spend = subscription + credits + add-ons. ROI multiple = net earnings ÷ marketplace spend — the number the ROI dashboard puts on the worker's home screen.

3.2 Worked example A — one job, end to end (Growth worker, gold lead)

Step	Amount	What happens
Customer requests plumbing job	—	Graded Gold (full profile + photos + signed in) = 20 credits
Worker buys the lead	–20 credits	Credit ledger debited, contact revealed, rivals' offers revoked
Worker accepts with quote	\$300.00	Fee stamped: 7% (Growth) × 300 = \$21.00, inside the \$5–\$300 band
Customer pays deposit (leg 1)	\$300.00	OMT reference → admin confirms → CONFIRMED; job is now funded
Job completed	—	Settlement engine: collected \$300 ≥ quote \$300 → credit 300 – 21
EARNING posted	+\$279.00	One row per booking (@@unique([bookingId])) — a redelivered confirm cannot double-credit
Lead rebate posts	+\$20.00	$\min(21 \times 100\%, 20, \infty)$ — platform keeps \$1 of the fee
Worker receives	\$299.00	Effective take rate on this job: 0.33% instead of 7%
Platform keeps	\$1.00	Plus the 20 credits already banked for the lead

Step	Amount	What happens
Worker requests payout	– \$279.00	PENDING reserves the amount → admin approves → PROCESSED

THE PATH NOT TAKEN

Had the parties settled in cash on the doorstep instead of paying through the platform, step "EARNING posted" would credit nothing: the worker declares "*we settled this directly*", the fee becomes a claim, and feeClaimPlan recovers it tranche-by-tranche from the worker's credit balance (real prepaid money) while the reconciliation lists any remainder for an admin to pursue or write off. Collection integrity beats fee collection.

3.3 Worked example B — monthly economics per plan tier

Illustrative monthly model (the projection carried in the source documentation; not a measurement).

Metric	Starter	Growth	Pro
Avg jobs / month	5	12	25
Avg job value	\$80	\$150	\$200
GMV	\$400	\$1,800	\$5,000
Platform fee (9% / 7% / 5%)	–\$36	–\$126	–\$250
Subscription cost	–\$15	–\$39	–\$99
Leads purchased (5/mo model)	–\$25	–\$45	–\$100
Net earnings to worker	\$324	\$1,590	\$4,551
ROI (earnings ÷ spend)	6.0×	17.1×	23.0×

What the same three workers return to the platform per month (illustrative).

Stream	Starter	Growth	Pro
Subscription	\$15.00	\$39.00	\$99.00
Take rate (net of rebates, shown gross here)	\$36.00	\$126.00	\$250.00
Lead credit purchases	\$12.50	\$22.50	\$50.00
Platform revenue per worker	\$63.50	\$187.50	\$399.00

3.4 The money waterfall (Pro tier, one month)

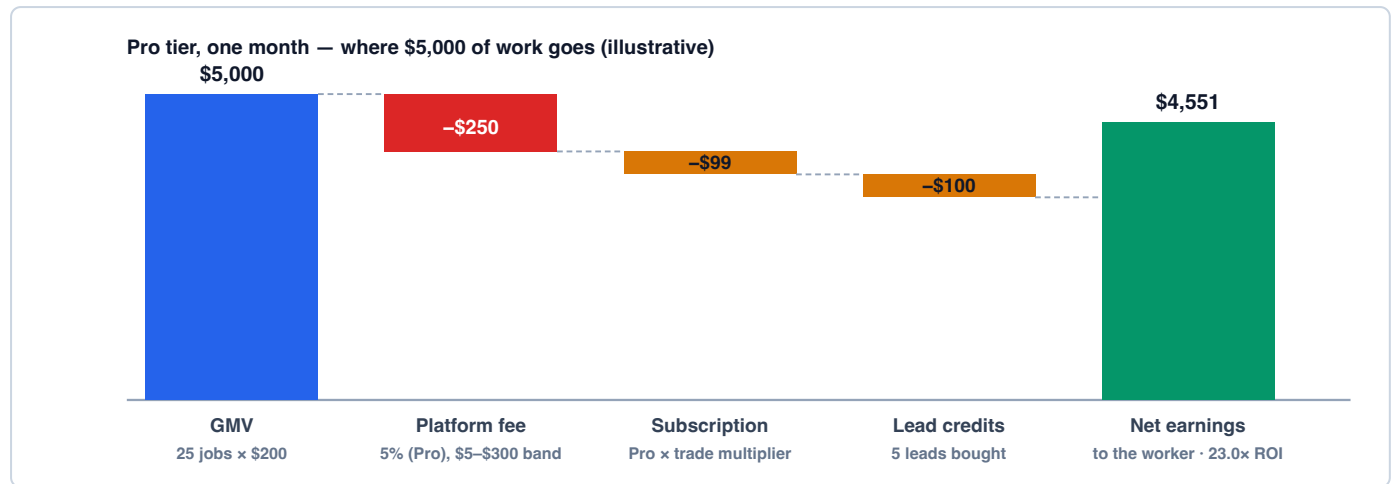
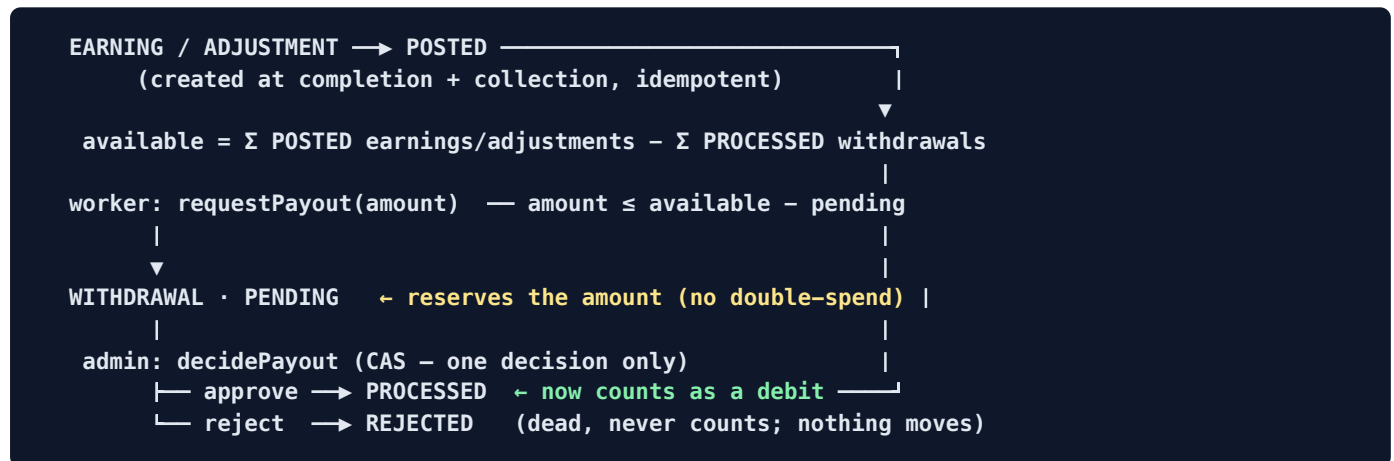


Figure 2 — The waterfall. Lead rebates are omitted for clarity: every rebate reduces the red bar, which is exactly the loyalty loop of §1.3-E.

3.5 Getting paid — the payout lifecycle



- Balance is derived, never stored. The ledger is the single source of truth; each row keeps only its own `balanceAfter` as an audit trail.
- The payout guard is one function (`payoutGuard`) used everywhere — and because every posted earning is funded by construction, an unfunded legacy credit can never be paid out.
- Approval ≠ transfer, today. `PROCESSED` currently means "admin approved"; wiring an actual provider payout (OMT transfer / Stripe Payouts) into the same seam is a §4 recommendation — the ledger model will not need to change.

3.6 The dashboards that measure the stream

ROI DASHBOARD leads bought · quotes sent · jobs won · GMV · platform fees · subscription cost · total marketplace spend · resulting multiple, per month	Earnings STATEMENT completed jobs · GMV · fees deducted · rebates applied · net earnings · per-job detail, per month	Analytics WORKER views · leads · completed jobs · conversion rate · avg job value · rating · response rate · actionable insights
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Admin

RETENTION & CHURN

trial-to-paid, churn,
upgrades/downgrades, lifetime,
renewal revenue/LTV, WhatsApp
outreach — from the
SubscriptionEvent ledger

Admin

RECONCILIATION

fee stamped vs collected · awaiting
customers · unbacked credit (must
be \$0) · blocked credit · outside-
platform claims — worst-first

Admin

LEAD QUALITY & SURGE

weekly rating trends, per-grade
conversion, price-multiplier
impact; 30-day emergency surge
verdict with CSV decision record

3.7 Four scenarios side by side

Scenario	What the platform collected	Fee	Worker credited	Note
Funded deposit job	\$300 (full quote)	\$21	\$279 + rebate	The classic path; payout released
Part-funded	\$100 deposit, \$200 balance unpaid	\$21	\$79 now, +\$200 as ADJUSTMENT	Worker sees "waiting for customer — \$200"
Cash on the doorstep	\$0	\$21 as claim	\$0	settledOutside; claim recovered from credit balance or written off
Cancelled per policy	Deposit refunded	\$0	\$0	The platform earns the fee only on completed jobs
Referral-injected month	—	—	+35 credits value	25 (referrer) + 10 (invitee) at first booking — free lead budget

Section 4 — Recommendations for Areas of Improvement

Grouped by theme, ordered by priority inside each theme. "Why" is grounded in the code and documentation as it stands today — including two deliberately deferred decisions (payment automation, and WhatsApp/Meta operations) that are called out as *deferred* rather than missing.

4.1 Monetisation — highest revenue leverage

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
1	Connect a payment gateway (Stripe first, then MyFatoorah/Tap/STC Pay) deferred by decision	Every purchase is admin-confirmed: latency is a conversion tax on renewals, credit top-ups and ad activation, and manual confirmation is ops load that scales linearly with GMV. The provider registry already makes a gateway a single-file change (PaymentProvider + registry), and production already refuses simulation — the seam is waiting.	Medium	Removes the #1 conversion friction; unlocks auto-renew (doc-cited 30–50% churn reduction) and self-serve ads
2	Escrow / milestone payments for large jobs	Deposits are routed but not held against completion. Holding funds until a photo/checklist milestone sells "protected payment" as a trust feature, raises achievable job values, and lets the platform earn its fee <i>at release</i> — plus float. Needs a licensed facilitator rather than the platform's own account (see §4.5).	High	+25% average job value (doc estimate) and a defensible trust differentiator
3	Turn advertising into a real market: CPM/CPC tiers, minimum budgets, pacing, self-serve portal	The ad product serves, tracks and bills — but at a flat demo price with no tiers, no pacing and activation requiring a human. Companies currently pay \$0. A tier structure (e.g. \$8/\$12/\$15 CPM by placement) plus a self-serve portal converts a built-but-dormant engine into recurring B2B revenue.	Medium	Second B2B revenue stream; doc projection \$2–10K/mo at 20 advertisers
4	Reduce cash leakage on outside-platform settlements	settledOutside jobs credit nothing and leave a fee claim. Product counter-measures: a visible "protected payment" CTA for customers, a reduced-but-nonzero declared-cash fee, and a weekly claim-status digest to admins. Every leaked job is 100% take-rate loss on work the platform sourced.	Low–Med	Recovers take rate already being forfeited
5	Ship the mid-cycle upgrade/downgrade flow with proration	The renewal dialog already previews the difference — but the change applies at renewal. Letting a worker upgrade immediately (credited for unused time) captures intent at the exact moment visibility hunger peaks: when they hit a lead-quota wall.	Low	ARPU migration; doc estimate +20%

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
6	Bundle the trust SKUs and annualise them	Verification (\$9/\$19), featured (\$49) and emergency (\$9) are sold separately with separate confirmations. A "Trust & Visibility" bundle and annual variants cut three confirmation loops to one and raise commitment.	Low	Higher attach rate; lower churn on add-ons
7	Tune lead pricing with the data you already collect	Smart pricing (0.7x–2.0x), quality multipliers (0.8x–1.2x) and the 30-day surge verdict all exist. What's missing is the discipline loop: use the surge report + lead-quality analytics to actually re-price grade floors monthly, and add urgency UI (expiry countdown, "3 workers viewing") to lift purchase conversion.	Low	Doc estimate +15% lead revenue, +30% purchase rate
8	Complete the payout rail (approval → actual money movement)	PROCESSED means "admin approved", not "money sent". Adding payout () to PaymentProvider and surfacing payouts in the earnings statement (the statement currently doesn't show payouts) makes the worker's end-to-end economics visible — which is what keeps them paying for subscriptions.	Medium	Trust + retention; honest financial reporting

4.2 Trust, quality & the demand side

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
9	Weight search ranking by review <i>volume</i> , not just average	Search scores bonus + rating × 3 — an average with no volume or recency term, so one 5★ review outranks eighty at 4.7. Since review solicitation now asks at completion, ranking is where that investment must pay; a Bayesian/volume-weighted score converts every new review into real marketplace signal.	Low	Quality signal reaches customers; rewards the workers who solicit
10	Add review-funnel analytics	There is no reviewRate/reviewsPerJob anywhere: nothing measures completed → solicited → reviewed → published, per-trade review rate, or moderation backlog. Without it the solicitation feature is unfalsifiable.	Low	Makes the last several releases measurable
11	Send the review ask off-platform (WhatsApp), with guardrails	The in-app prompt only reaches customers who come back — a minority after a job. A WhatsApp nudge reuses the delivery ledger, retry policy and health snapshot already built; it needs one new piece of state (reviewAskedAt + bounded reminder count) so it can never nag.	Medium	More reviews → better ranking → better demand conversion

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
1 2	Finish the verification ladder (licence → background check as paid tiers)	The trust types exist but the higher-value background-check monetisation is not wired end-to-end. Trust is the single most price-elastic thing a worker will buy on a marketplace where customers fear no-shows.	Medium	New high-margin stream; conversion lift for customers
1 3	Surface rating-driven price changes fully in the admin panel	The lead-quality feedback engine is built, but the admin visibility of rating-driven per-grade multiplier changes is partial. An operator who can't see why a price moved won't trust — or use — the loop.	Low	Closes the lead-quality loop operationally
1 4	Guard lead-refund abuse with the rating signal	One refund per lead is generous; combine it with the 1–5 lead ratings so a worker who rates poorly <i>and</i> refunds repeatedly is flagged. Protects the refund policy's intent (trust) from becoming a free credit path.	Low	Limits credit leakage

4.3 Operations, data & engineering discipline

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
1 5	Automate the weekly money digest	The weekly admin WhatsApp digest already carries the surge summary. Extend it with: reconciliation's unbacked-credit canary, outstanding fee claims, pending payouts, retention risk, and ad spend — one message that keeps every revenue surface visible.	Low	Decisions actually get made weekly
1 6	Prove the model with a live-cohort revenue report	Projections (\$3.8K → \$127K) are modelled, and "Current" KPI cells still read <i>Unknown</i> / \$0. A monthly report from real Payment, Invoice, PlatformFeeSnapshot and SubscriptionEvent rows — MRR, ARPU, take-rate revenue, lead revenue, conversion, churn — replaces assumption with measurement.	Medium	Every pricing decision becomes evidence-based
1 7	Keep regenerating the money documents	The Word manual and revenue test guide lag code changes (a past gap meant testers exercised a removed settlement rule). The docs:manual generator exists — put regeneration in the release checklist so the PDF/DOCX a partner reads always matches production.	Low	Removes a recurring source of wrong decisions

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
18	Production marketplace freshness	An empty-looking marketplace depresses every funnel above it. The seed script funds completed jobs correctly now; formalise a demo-data refresh for public demo environments and, in real operations, monitor "time to first job" as a first-class KPI.	Low	Cold-start credibility
19	Keep CI honest (already started — continue)	The scripts gate and the no-masked-checks tests close one class of silent failure. Extend the same "no true" discipline to remaining pipeline steps and add a deploy-time route/manifest check so a hidden file can never again vanish from a deployment.	Low	Prevents regressions that only appear in production
20	Verify Meta WhatsApp operations when un-deferred	The delivery ledger, webhook, retry sweep and admin audit view are built; live Meta sending is explicitly pending credential/webhook configuration in production. When that work resumes, the exact remaining steps are already documented — treat them as a checklist, not a redesign.	Low (config)	Delivery visibility for all outreach

4.4 Growth & expansion

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
21	Second city, then second country	Tripoli/Sidon/Jounieh are catalog edits that instantly create new featured-slot and lead inventory; the multi-country plan already defines how a tenant, currency and locale flip. 3–5× TAM without new product.	Low–Med	TAM growth, new inventory to sell
22	Company CRM / lead-gen seats	Companies already buy ads; seats with lead routing, pacing alerts and anonymised market-rate reports turn one-off budgets into B2B ARR (\$99–\$499/mo range in the plan).	High	Recurring B2B revenue with expansion
23	Loyalty on the demand side	Customers are (correctly) free — but a booking-loyalty perk (fee discount after N jobs, surfaced to the worker as a perk too) compounds repeat GMV without taxing acquisition.	Low	Repeat GMV, lower effective CAC
24	Adjacent verticals	Supplier marketplace (materials/tools), insurance partnerships (worker liability commission), and training/certification marketplace (high-margin digital goods) all reuse the credit + invoice + ledger machinery already built.	High	New revenue verticals on existing rails

#	Recommendation	Why it matters	Effort	Expected impact
2 5	Mobile-first monetisation	The PWA (installable, push, camera proof-of-work) is the highest-intent channel. Push-driven emergency dispatch with an in-app payment path is where urgent, high-value work will transact.	Medium	Conversion on the highest-intent channel

4.5 Risk, compliance & model guardrails

- **VAT / tax on fees and subscriptions.** Platform fees and subscriptions are tax events in most MENA markets (KSA 15%, UAE 5%). Price displays are USD and tax-naïve today — decide explicitly whether tax is inclusive before expanding countries, and store the tax component on invoices from the start.
- **Money-holding rules for escrow.** Recommendation #2 must be implemented *through a licensed facilitator or the gateway's own escrow*, never the platform's own account — otherwise a trust feature becomes a regulatory liability.
- **Refund exposure.** Keep the platform fee refundable with a cancelled booking (current behaviour) — or charge only at completion — so a cancellation wave never turns into customer backlash. Watch the 24h window's effect on worker income and adjust with data, not anecdotes.
- **Cash-dominant payment culture.** Cash on delivery is normal in the region; if cash jobs bypass the platform entirely, the take rate misses most transactions. Recommendation #4 is the counterweight — make paying through the platform visibly safer *and* cheap enough to be the default.
- **Supply-side price sensitivity.** Informal workers are cost-sensitive: keep Starter cheap, let the rebate and volume justify the take rate, and always market "jobs, not just views". Never raise the take rate before booking volume demonstrably rises.
- **Two-sided cold start.** Continue not taxing the demand side. Every proposed fee belongs on supply or companies until network effects are established.
- **Single-currency assumption.** USD-only is fine for Lebanon; a second tenant currency must not leak into ledgers — mixed-currency workers are a documented concern for the multi-country wave, not a bug to discover late.

4.6 Suggested sequencing

Horizon	Do first	Because
Now (0–1 month)	#16 revenue report, #15 digest, #9 review-weighted ranking, #10 funnel metrics, #5 upgrade flow, #7 pricing discipline, #17 doc regeneration	All are low-effort, and most convert work already shipped into <i>measured</i> outcomes
Next (1–3 months)	#1 gateway, #3 ad tiers + self-serve, #4 cash leakage, #6 bundles, #8 payout rail, #11 off-platform review ask, #12 verification ladder	The payments wave is the prerequisite the plan itself names — everything else here amplifies it
Strategic (3–12 months)	#2 escrow (with a facilitator), #21 second city/country, #22 company CRM seats, #24 verticals, #25 mobile monetisation	TAM and margin bets that need the collection foundation to be trustworthy first

THE ONE-SENTENCE STRATEGY

The model is already broad — fourteen streams, all admin-configurable, all collectable on Lebanon's manual rails. The next dollar of revenue comes less from *adding* a stream than from automating collection on the streams that exist (#1, #3, #8), defending the take rate against cash leakage (#4), and turning the quality signals you already record into ranking and pricing decisions (#9, #10, #7).

End of document · WorkersArena Business Model, Usage Guide & Worker Revenue Stream · Version 1.0 · 23 September 2026

Sources: docs/BUSINESS-MODEL.md · BUSINESS-MODEL-SUMMARY.md · REVENUE-STREAMS.md · PAYMENTS.md · booking-settlement.md · booking-take-rate.md · payouts.md · ADVERTISING-SYSTEM.md · production at <https://workers-arena.vercel.app>

All prices and rates are admin-editable defaults as implemented; illustrative figures are projections, not measurements.